

Engineering Report: Dynamic Sensor-Fusion Routing

1. System Overview

Fire Commander utilizes a centralized graph-based network where hallways and rooms are **Edges** and intersections/exits are **Nodes**. To route occupants safely during an emergency, the system employs **Dijkstra's Algorithm** to find the path of least resistance (lowest total weight).

Instead of relying on static distances, the system fuses real-time telemetry (Temperature, Smoke PPM, and Flame Detection) to dynamically penalize paths that are becoming dangerous.

2. Sensor-Fusion Flowchart

The following flowchart illustrates the exact decision tree used to convert raw sensor data into actionable edge-weights for the pathfinding engine.

```
graph TD
    %% Input Layer
    Sensors((Sensors)) --> Temp[Temp: Temperature °C]
    Sensors --> Smoke[Smoke: PPM]
    Sensors --> Flame[Flame: Optical Flame Sensor]

    %% Evaluation Layer
    Flame --> EvalFlame{EvalFlame: Flame Detected?}
    Temp --> EvalTempSmoke{EvalTempSmoke}
    Smoke --> EvalTempSmoke

    EvalFlame -- Yes --> Blocked[Block: Hazard Level: BLOCKED]
    EvalFlame -- No --> EvalTempSmoke

    EvalTempSmoke -- "Temp > 60°C OR Smoke > 200ppm" --> Danger[Danger: Hazard Level: DANGER]
    EvalTempSmoke -- "Temp > 45°C OR Smoke > 100ppm" --> Warning[Warning: Hazard Level: WARNING]
    EvalTempSmoke -- "Temp > 35°C OR Smoke > 50ppm" --> Caution[Caution: Hazard Level: CAUTION]
    EvalTempSmoke -- "Normal Conditions" --> Safe[Safe: Hazard Level: SAFE]

    %% Weight Calculation Layer
    Blocked --> W_Inf[W_Inf: Weight Penalty = Infinity]
    Danger --> W_Dan[W_Dan: Weight Penalty = Base Weight x 5.0]
    Warning --> W_Warn[W_Warn: Weight Penalty = Base Weight x 2.5]
    Caution --> W_Cau[W_Cau: Weight Penalty = Base Weight x 1.5]
    Safe --> W_Safe[W_Safe: Weight Penalty = Base Weight x 1.0]

    %% Routing Layer
    W_Inf --> GraphUpdate[GraphUpdate: Graph Context Update]
    W_Dan --> GraphUpdate
    W_Warn --> GraphUpdate
    W_Cau --> GraphUpdate
    W_Safe --> GraphUpdate

    GraphUpdate --> Dijkstra[Dijkstra: Dijkstra Pathfinding Recalculation]
    Dijkstra --> UI[UI: Push New Paths to Smart Signs]
    Dijkstra --> HVAC[HVAC: Trigger HVAC / Fire Door Overrides]
```

3. Mathematical Weighting Model

The traversal cost (\$C\$) of any given edge (\$E\$) is calculated dynamically using the base distance (\$D\$) and a hazard penalty multiplier (\$P_h\$).

$$C_E = D_E \times P_h$$

Hazard Penalties (\$P_h\$)

- SAFE (\$P_h = 1.0\$):** Normal walking speed. Occupants can traverse the area safely.
- CAUTION (\$P_h = 1.5\$):** Slight smoke or heat. Path is viable but less optimal.
- WARNING (\$P_h = 2.5\$):** Moderate smoke. Visibility is dropping. The algorithm will strongly prefer longer, clearer routes unless no other option exists.
- DANGER (\$P_h = 5.0\$):** Heavy smoke or dangerous heat. The algorithm will route occupants through this edge *only* as an absolute last resort to escape.
- BLOCKED (\$P_h = \infty\$):** Active flame detected. The edge is severed mathematically. The algorithm will drop this edge from the graph entirely.

4. Real-World Scalability

This localized edge-weight calculation allows the system to scale massively. Because edge weights are only updated when a sensor in that specific zone crosses a threshold, the computational overhead is extremely low. The central server (or distributed edge nodes) only needs to re-run the Dijkstra algorithm on the graph when an edge's \$P_h\$ state actively changes.